Indian States, Major Festivals, Dances, Drama Forms, Crops and Important Events

1. Overview

India is known for its diversity in culture, food, festivals, dance forms, theatre traditions and agriculture. Every state has its own identity, celebrated through festivals, folk performance forms, local traditions and major crops. Drama and theatre are an important part of Indian cultural life because they preserve history, mythology, social values and regional languages.

2. States and Their Major Festivals, Dances, Drama Forms and Crops

State/UT	Major Festivals	Famous Dance Forms	Drama/Theatre Forms	Main Crops	Important Event/Note
Andhra Pradesh	Ugadi, Sankranti, Tirumala Brahmotsavam	Kuchipudi, Vilasini Natyam	Burrakatha, Veeragase	Rice, tobacco, cotton, mango	Tirumala temple festivals are very famous
Arunachal Pradesh	Losar, Solung, Dree	Bardo Chham, Aji Lamu	Tribal masked theatre and storytelling	Rice, maize, millet	Tribal culture and festivals are central to life
Assam	Bihu, Ambubachi Mela, Durga Puja	Bihu dance, Sattriya	Bhaona, Ankia Naat	Tea, rice, jute	Rongali Bihu is the most important spring festival
Bihar	Chhath Puja, Holi, Sama Chakeva	Jat-Jatin, Bidesia	Folk drama and village storytelling	Rice, wheat, maize, sugarcane	Chhath Puja is a major river-side festival
Chhattisgarh	Bastar Dussehra, Madai, Pola	Panthi, Raut Nacha	Traditional tribal theatre	Rice, millets, pulses	Bastar Dussehra is world-famous
Goa	Carnival, Shigmo, Christmas	Fugdi, Dhalo	Goan folk theatre and stage performances	Coconut, cashew, rice	Carnival is the most celebrated event
Gujarat	Navratri, Janmashtami, Rann Utsav	Garba, Dandiya, Tippani	Bhavai, folk stage drama	Cotton, groundnut, tobacco	Garba is a major cultural identity
Haryana	Teej, Baisakhi, Surajkund Mela	Khoria, Jhumar	Rural theatrical forms and folk drama	Wheat, mustard, bajra	Surajkund Mela draws tourists from all over
Himachal Pradesh	Kullu Dussehra, Losar, Shivratri	Nati, Dangi	Folk theatre and local performance traditions	Apple, wheat, barley, maize	Kullu Dussehra is very famous
Jharkhand	Sarhul, Karma, Tusu Parab	Chhau, Jhumar	Chhau performance and tribal theatre	Rice, maize, pulses	Sarhul marks the beginning of the agricultural season
Karnataka	Ugadi, Mysuru Dasara, Pongal	Yakshagana, Dollu Kunitha	Yakshagana, Bayalata	Rice, ragi, coffee, sugarcane	Mysuru Dasara is a grand royal celebration
Kerala	Onam, Vishu, Thrissur Pooram	Kathakali, Mohiniyattam, Theyyam	Kathakali, Koothu	Coconut, rubber, tea, spices	Thrissur Pooram is a spectacular temple festival
Madhya Pradesh	Navratri, Khajuraho Dance Festival, Tansen Samaroh	Tertali, Gaur Maria dance	Folk theatre and rasa-based performances	Wheat, soybean, gram, cotton	Khajuraho Dance Festival is internationally known
Maharashtra	Ganesh Chaturthi, Gudi Padwa, Diwali	Lavani, Tamasha	Tamasha, Dashavatara	Sugarcane, mango, cotton, jowar	Ganeshotsav is one of the largest festivals
Manipur	Yaosang, Lai Haraoba, Cheiraoba	Manipuri dance	Ras Lila and ritual theatre	Rice, sugarcane, pulses	Manipuri dance is a classical heritage

State/UT	Major Festivals	Famous Dance Forms	Drama/Theatre Forms	Main Crops	Important Event/Note
Meghalaya	Wangala, Shad Suk Mynsiem, Behdeinkhlam	Nongkrem dance, traditional bamboo dance	Traditional community drama and folk performance	Rice, maize, potato	Wangala is the harvest festival
Mizoram	Chapchar Kut, Mim Kut, Pawl Kut	Cheraw (Bamboo Dance)	Folk theatre and festival performances	Rice, maize, pulses	Chapchar Kut celebrates spring and harvest
Nagaland	Hornbill Festival, Sekrenyi, Moatsu	War dance, traditional folk dances	Tribal theatre and ceremonial performances	Rice, millet, pulses	Hornbill Festival showcases tribal culture
Odisha	Raja, Durga Puja, Konark Dance Festival	Odissi, Chhau	Jatra, Chhau performance	Rice, pulses, coconut, sugarcane	Konark Dance Festival is important for classical dance
Punjab	Baisakhi, Lohri, Hola Mohalla	Bhangra, Gidda	Folk stage drama and local theatre	Wheat, rice, cotton, sugarcane	Baisakhi is the harvest and new-year festival
Rajasthan	Teej, Gangaur, Desert Festival	Ghoomar, Kalbelia	Bhavai, Rammat and folk theatre	Bajra, wheat, pulses, mustard	Desert Festival is a major cultural event
Sikkim	Losar, Saga Dawa, Dasain	Chaam dance	Buddhist masked theatre and ritual drama	Cardamom, maize, rice	Sikkim's Buddhist festivals are very special
Tamil Nadu	Pongal, Deepavali, Chithirai Festival	Bharatanatyam, Karagattam	Koothu, Therukoothu	Rice, sugarcane, millets, groundnut	Pongal is the most important harvest festival
Telangana	Bathukamma, Bonalu, Sankranti	Perini Shivatandavam, Gorinta	Burrakatha, folk street plays	Rice, cotton, maize, pulses	Bonalu is the most iconic festival of Hyderabad
Tripura	Kharchi Puja, Poush Sankranti, Durga Puja	Hojagiri, Garia	Traditional folk theatre	Rice, rubber, tea, pineapple	Kharchi Puja is a traditional festival
Uttar Pradesh	Holi, Diwali, Maha Kumbh	Kathak, Raslila	Ramlila, Nautanki	Wheat, sugarcane, rice, potato	Kumbh Mela is one of the largest gatherings
Uttarakhand	Harela, Nanda Devi Raj Jat, Kumbh	Garhwali folk dance, Langvir Nritya	Folk theatre and devotional performances	Rice, wheat, mandua, apple	Nanda Devi Raj Jat is a grand cultural event
West Bengal	Durga Puja, Poila Boishakh, Kali Puja	Rabindra Nritya, Chhau	Jatra, Yatra	Rice, jute, tea, potato	Durga Puja is one of the biggest festivals

3. Important Drama and Theatre Forms of India

Drama/Theatre Form	State/Region	What it is	Why it is important
Kathakali	Kerala	A classical dance-drama with elaborate makeup, costume and expressive gestures	It depicts stories from epics and is a major cultural symbol of Kerala
Bharatanatyam	Tamil Nadu	A graceful classical dance form that often tells mythological stories	It is one of the oldest classical dance traditions of India
Yakshagana	Karnataka	A folk theatre form combining dance, music, dialogue and costume	It is very popular in coastal Karnataka and is known for its dramatic storytelling
Tamasha	Maharashtra	A lively folk theatre form with music, satire and social themes	It reflects the spirit of rural Maharashtra and everyday life
Jatra	West Bengal and Odisha	A popular street and stage theatre tradition	It is widely used to present religious, historical and social stories
Bhaona	Assam	A traditional performance based on religious themes	It is associated with the Vaishnavite tradition and Satra culture
Ramlila	North India	A dramatic performance of the Ramayana	It is performed during Dussehra and teaches moral values
Nautanki	Uttar Pradesh	A folk theatre style with music and dramatic narration	It is one of the most influential popular theatre traditions of North India
Chhau	Jharkhand and Odisha	A masked dance-drama form	It combines martial arts, dance and storytelling
Therukoothu	Tamil Nadu	A village theatre tradition performed in open spaces	It is used to spread social messages and religious stories

4. Important Mountains, Peaks and Animals of India

A. Important Mountains and Peaks

Mountain/Peak/Range	Location	Description
Himalayas	Northern India	The highest mountain system in the world; it influences climate, rivers and culture
Karakoram Range	Ladakh and Jammu and Kashmir	Known for some of the highest peaks and glaciers in the world
Western Ghats	Peninsular India	A major mountain range running parallel to the west coast; rich in biodiversity
Eastern Ghats	Eastern coast	Lower than the Western Ghats but important for ecology and forests
Aravalli Range	Rajasthan	One of the oldest fold mountain systems in the world
Vindhya Range	Central India	A historic range associated with ancient Indian geography and culture
Kanchenjunga	Sikkim	The third highest mountain in the world and one of the most famous peaks in India
Nanda Devi	Uttarakhand	One of the highest peaks in India and a holy mountain in Hindu tradition
Mount Everest	Nepal/China, near India	Not in India, but closely linked with Himalayan geography and Indian mountaineering interest
Kamet	Uttarakhand	A very high peak in the Garhwal Himalayas

B. Important Animals of India

Animal	Region/State	Why it is important
Bengal Tiger	Sundarbans, Central India, Madhya Pradesh	India's most famous wild animal and a symbol of conservation
Indian Elephant	North-east, southern forests, Assam	Important for forest ecology and cultural significance
Asiatic Lion	Gir Forest, Gujarat	Found only in Gujarat and is a unique species of India
One-horned Rhinoceros	Assam	Found in Kaziranga National Park; one of the most iconic Indian animals
Snow Leopard	Himalayas	Found in high-altitude regions and is a rare mountain animal
Nilgiri Tahr	Western Ghats	A mountain goat found only in the southern hills of India
Indian Rhinoceros	Assam	Another important large mammal of the grasslands and riverine areas
Gangetic Dolphin	Ganga river system	A rare freshwater dolphin found in India's major rivers

5. Important State Capitals and Famous Personalities

State/UT	Capital	Famous Personality/Link
Andhra Pradesh	Amaravati/Visakhapatnam	Sri Sathya Sai Baba, P. V. Narasimha Rao
Assam	Dispur	Bhupen Hazarika, Srimanta Sankardeva
Bihar	Patna	Chanakya, B.R. Ambedkar
Gujarat	Gandhinagar	Mahatma Gandhi, Sardar Patel
Karnataka	Bengaluru	Kuvempu, Dr. A. P. J. Abdul Kalam
Kerala	Thiruvananthapuram	Swami Vivekananda, Sree Narayana Guru
Maharashtra	Mumbai	Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj, Sachin Tendulkar
Odisha	Bhubaneswar	Utkal Gaurav Madhusudan Das, Jayadev
Punjab	Chandigarh	Guru Nanak, Bhagat Singh
Rajasthan	Jaipur	Maharana Pratap, Kalidas
Tamil Nadu	Chennai	Thiruvalluvar, Subramania Bharati
Uttar Pradesh	Lucknow	Tulsidas, Akbar
West Bengal	Kolkata	Rabindranath Tagore, Netaji Subhas Chandra Bose

6. Important National Parks and Wildlife Sanctuaries

Place	State	Famous For
Kaziranga National Park	Assam	One-horned rhinoceros
Jim Corbett National Park	Uttarakhand	Tigers and elephants
Ranthambore National Park	Rajasthan	Tigers
Periyar Wildlife Sanctuary	Kerala	Elephants and biodiversity
Gir National Park	Gujarat	Asiatic lions
Sundarbans National Park	West Bengal	Royal Bengal tiger and mangroves
Nagarhole National Park	Karnataka	Tigers and wildlife
Bandipur National Park	Karnataka	Elephants and tigers
Manas National Park	Assam	UNESCO site and diverse wildlife
Kanha National Park	Madhya Pradesh	Tigers and barasingha

7. Important Union Territories

Union Territory	Major Festival	Famous Dance/Tradition	Main Crops/Notes
Delhi	Diwali, Holi, Durga Puja	Kathak, folk performances	Wheat, vegetables, dairy products
Chandigarh	Diwali, Baisakhi, Teej	Punjabi folk dance	Wheat, vegetables, flowers
Jammu and Kashmir	Navratri, Eid, Baisakhi	Rouf, Dumhal	Apples, saffron, rice
Ladakh	Losar, Hemis Festival	Cham dance	Barley, apricots, peas
Puducherry	Pongal, Bastille Day, Deepavali	Bharatanatyam, folk dance	Rice, sugarcane, vegetables
Andaman and Nicobar Islands	Durga Puja, Christmas, Island Tourism Festival	Tribal dance forms	Coconut, arecanut, spices
Lakshadweep	Eid, Muharram, Christmas	Traditional island folk performances	Coconut, tuna, fishery
Dadra and Nagar Haveli, Daman and Diu	Holi, Diwali, Christmas	Folk dances and local cultural events	Rice, coconut, vegetables

8. Quick Revision Points

- India is rich in cultural diversity.
- Festivals often reflect religion, harvest, season and local traditions.
- Drama and theatre forms such as Kathakali, Yakshagana, Tamasha, Jatra and Ramlila are important cultural heritage.
- Classical dances such as Bharatanatyam, Kathak, Odissi and Manipuri are important cultural heritage.
- Folk dances such as Garba, Bhangra, Ghoomar, Lavani, Chhau and Cheraw express regional identity.
- Mountains and peaks shape India's climate, rivers and biodiversity.
- Animals like the tiger, elephant, lion, rhinoceros and snow leopard are symbols of India's natural wealth.

9. One-Line Memory Capsule

- Bihu — Assam
- Chhath — Bihar
- Onam — Kerala
- Pongal — Tamil Nadu
- Navratri — Gujarat and Madhya Pradesh
- Baisakhi — Punjab
- Durga Puja — West Bengal
- Hornbill Festival — Nagaland
- Kumbh Mela — Uttar Pradesh
- Garba — Gujarat
- Kathakali — Kerala
- Tamasha — Maharashtra
- Kanchenjunga — Sikkim
- Nanda Devi — Uttarakhand
- Bengal Tiger — India's famous wildlife symbol